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November 11, 2025

Search Committee
Department of Economics & Business
Hope College
Holland, MI 49423
USA

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the open-rank tenure-track faculty position in economics at Hope College, beginning Fall 2026. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My research fields are macroeconomics, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda is unified by a focus on understanding the determinants of wealth inequality and the mechanisms through which heterogeneity in returns to wealth shapes aggregate outcomes. In my job-market paper, I estimate the degree of heterogeneity in individual portfolio returns using micro-data from the Survey of Consumer Finances and simulate a structural model in which households face idiosyncratic return risk. I show that allowing for persistent heterogeneity in returns substantially improves the model's ability to match the empirical distribution of wealth, offering a tractable way to connect micro-level return dispersion to macroeconomic inequality.

In a second project, I use the Health and Retirement Study to study the relationship between interpersonal trust and portfolio performance. Building on the literature that finds a hump-shaped relationship between trust and income, I show that a similar relationship holds for individual returns to wealth measured in the HRS data, highlighting a behavioral channel through which social attitudes shape saving and investment outcomes. This work also provides new estimates of the persistent component of returns to net worth, which motivate the calibration of heterogeneity in my structural model.

Hope College's Department of Economics & Business values teaching excellence, undergraduate mentoring, and a liberal-arts environment grounded in the historic Christian faith. I am deeply drawn to this mission and believe my experience and interests align strongly with the goals of your department and the college more broadly.

Teaching. My teaching experience centers on undergraduate macroeconomics and an upper-level macro-policy seminar, where I have led weekly discussion sections and held regular office hours for classes ranging from 16 to 40 students. My approach is student-centered: I aim to help students "convince themselves" that they have moved from confusion to understanding by holding structured office-hour coaching that builds trust and confidence. At Hope College, I am prepared to teach *Principles of Macroeconomics*, *Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory*, *Money and Banking*, and *Quantitative Methods for Economics*. I would also welcome developing electives such as *Economics of*

Inequality and Tax Policy or *Computational Macroeconomics and Policy*, emphasizing reproducible workflows and evidence-based decision-making.

I believe I would be a strong fit because my computational and empirical toolkit allows me to (i) produce robust, data-backed estimates of returns and distributional outcomes, (ii) build and validate models that speak to macroeconomic and distributional questions in an undergraduate liberal-arts context, and (iii) collaborate with faculty and mentor students to present insights in clear, actionable formats. I am enthusiastic about joining Hope College's vibrant, mission-driven community and contributing to teaching, scholarship, and service.

I would be honored to join Hope College's Department of Economics & Business and to support its mission of combining intellectual rigor, Christian faith, and student-focused mentoring. Thank you for your consideration; I welcome the opportunity to discuss my fit with your department at your convenience.

Sincerely,

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